

Day 29 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Citizenship

READING MATERIAL

Covers Part II of the Constitution (Articles 5-11) and the Citizenship Act, 1955. Real exam evidence shows TNPSC favors testing this via true/false statement combinations and deliberately mis-paired mode-definitions over plain recall.

Q: Which Articles of the Constitution deal with citizenship, and what do they broadly cover?

A: Articles 5-11 (Part II). Article 5: citizenship at the Constitution's commencement (domicile in India). Article 6: rights of those who migrated from Pakistan before 19 July 1948. Article 7: rights of those who migrated to Pakistan and later returned. Article 8: citizenship rights of persons of Indian origin residing outside India. Article 9: voluntarily acquiring another country's citizenship ends Indian citizenship. Article 10: continuance of citizenship rights subject to law. Article 11: empowers PARLIAMENT to make laws regulating citizenship — exercised via the Citizenship Act, 1955.

Q: What are the FIVE modes of acquiring Indian citizenship under the Citizenship Act, 1955?

A: Birth, Descent, Registration, Naturalisation, and Incorporation of Territory.

Q: Real exam: What is Citizenship by Descent, and what date range governs the most commonly tested version of this rule?

A: A person born OUTSIDE India is a citizen by descent if a parent was a citizen of India at the time of birth. The classic tested date range: born outside India on or after 26 January 1950 but before 10 December 1992 — citizen by descent if the FATHER was an Indian citizen at the time of birth (rules for births after 1992 require either parent, with added conditions).

Q: Real exam trap: What is Citizenship by Registration actually defined as (distinct from Naturalisation and Incorporation of Territory)?

A: Registration applies to specific categories (e.g., a person of Indian origin, or a person married to an Indian citizen, ordinarily resident in India for a qualifying period, or minor children of Indian citizens) applying for registration — NOT simply 'any foreigner applying.' A real exam question deliberately swapped this description with Naturalisation's definition as a trap; only the Descent pairing in that question was correct.

Q: Real exam trap: What is Citizenship by Naturalisation, and what is Citizenship by Incorporation of Territory — and how did a real exam swap them?

A: Naturalisation: the Central Government grants a citizenship certificate to a foreigner (not an illegal migrant) who applies and meets residency/character qualifications (broadly ~12 years' residence in India under the Act's specific formula). Incorporation of Territory: if a new/foreign territory becomes part of India, the Government of India specifies by order which persons of that territory become Indian citizens. A real TNPSC question paired 'Naturalisation' with the Incorporation-of-Territory description (new territory becoming part of India) — incorrect pairing, a classic mode-swap trap.

Q: Real exam: What are the three ways an Indian can lose citizenship, and what specific grounds were tested together as all TRUE in one real question?

A: Three ways: Renunciation (voluntary giving up), Termination (automatically ceasing on voluntarily acquiring another country's citizenship, per Article 9/Section 9), and Deprivation (Government strips citizenship under specified grounds under Section 10 — e.g., fraud, disloyalty, trading with the enemy, imprisonment of 2+ years, or 7 continuous years' residence abroad without registering intent to retain citizenship). A real exam confirmed ALL THREE of: (1) voluntarily acquiring another country's citizenship, (2) being ordinarily resident abroad continuously for 7 years, and (3) being imprisoned for 2 years, as valid grounds.

Q: Does India recognise dual/multiple citizenship?

A: No — India recognises only SINGLE citizenship (one of the Constitution's 'unitary' features, unlike countries such as the USA which allow dual citizenship at the state and federal level). The Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) card is NOT full dual citizenship — it is a long-term visa-like status with limited rights, not equivalent to citizenship.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Citizenship is dealt with in which Articles of the Indian Constitution?

A. Articles 1-4

B. Articles 5-11 ✓

C. Articles 12-35

D. Articles 36-51

Explanation: Articles 5-11, Part II. [easy, web-research]

2. Which Article empowers Parliament to make laws regulating the acquisition and termination of citizenship?

- A. Article 8
- B. Article 9
- C. Article 10

D. Article 11 ✓

Explanation: Article 11. [medium, web-research]

3. The Citizenship Act, 1955 provides for how many modes of acquiring Indian citizenship?

- A. Three
- B. Four
- C. Five ✓**
- D. Six

Explanation: Five: Birth, Descent, Registration, Naturalisation, Incorporation of Territory. [easy, web-research]

4. Which one of the following is correctly paired with its mode of acquiring citizenship? (1) Citizenship by Descent — a person born outside India on/after 26 Jan 1950 but before 10 Dec 1992, whose father was a citizen of India at the time of birth. (2) Citizenship by Registration — a foreigner, not an Indian migrant, can acquire citizenship simply on application for registration. (3) Citizenship by Naturalisation — if new territory becomes part of India, the Government specifies who among its people shall be citizens.

- A. (1) and (3) only
- B. (1) only ✓**
- C. (2) only
- D. (2) and (3) only

Explanation: Only (1) is correctly paired — (2) actually describes Naturalisation, and (3) actually describes Incorporation of Territory. [hard, question-bank-2026]

5. Which of the following are valid ways of losing Indian citizenship under the Constitution? (1) Voluntarily acquiring the citizenship of another country. (2) Being ordinarily resident in any country for 7 years continuously. (3) Being imprisoned in any country for 2 years.

- A. (1) and (2) only
- B. (2) and (3) only
- C. (2) only

D. (1), (2), and (3) ✓

Explanation: All three are valid grounds (via termination and deprivation provisions). [hard, question-bank-2026]

6. Under Article 9, what happens if an Indian citizen voluntarily acquires the citizenship of another country?

- A. Nothing — India allows dual citizenship
- B. Indian citizenship is automatically terminated ✓**
- C. They must seek Presidential approval first
- D. Only their voting rights are suspended

Explanation: Indian citizenship is automatically terminated. [medium, authored]

7. The three broad ways of losing Indian citizenship are renunciation, termination, and:

- A. Naturalisation
- B. Registration
- C. Deprivation ✓**
- D. Incorporation

Explanation: Deprivation. [medium, authored]

8. Does the Indian Constitution recognise dual citizenship?

- A. Yes, for all citizens
- B. Yes, but only via the OCI card
- C. No — only single citizenship ✓**
- D. Yes, but only for NRIs

Explanation: No — single citizenship only; OCI is not full dual citizenship. [medium, authored]

9. Citizenship by Naturalisation is granted to:

- A. Anyone born in India after 1987
- B. A foreigner (not an illegal migrant) who applies and meets residency/qualification conditions ✓**

C. Only persons of Indian origin

D. Only minor children of Indian citizens

Explanation: A foreigner who applies and meets the Act's residency/qualification conditions. [medium, authored]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Dice

READING MATERIAL

Dice is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills. Real exam evidence (explicitly tagged by source year, 2013-2025) shows two distinct shapes: opposite-face deduction from multiple cube views, and dice-throw probability.

Q: Foundational rule: On a standard die, what do opposite faces always sum to, and why does this matter for solving these puzzles?

A: Opposite faces always sum to 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4) on a STANDARD die — but TNPSC dice puzzles often use lettered or non-standard-numbered faces specifically to stop you from relying on this shortcut, forcing you to actually deduce relationships from the given views instead.

Q: Method — deducing an opposite face from adjacency information: If face 2 is adjacent to faces 3, 5, and 6, what must be true about face 1's relationship to face 4?

A: Since 2 is adjacent to 3, 5, and 6, those three faces can't be opposite 2 — leaving only 1 or 4 as 2's possible opposite. With four faces (3,5,6, and whichever of 1/4 is also adjacent) surrounding face 2, the remaining face must be its opposite, and separately, on a standard 6-face die, this kind of constraint typically forces 1 and 4 to be adjacent to each other (since they're not the 2-pair) — real exam answer: '1 is necessarily adjacent to 4.'

Q: Method — three views of a cube → find the opposite face: Three pictures of the same cube show different combinations of visible letters/numbers. How do you find what's opposite a given face?

A: A face that appears on multiple different views, each time paired with DIFFERENT other visible faces, helps you eliminate possibilities — any face that has been seen adjacent to your target face (in ANY view) cannot be its opposite. Whatever face is never seen adjacent to it across all views is the opposite face.

Q: Method — probability of a sum from two dice: What is the probability of getting a prime-number sum when throwing two dice?

A: Possible sums range 2-12 (36 total equally likely outcomes from 6×6). Prime sums possible: 2,3,5,7,11. Count outcomes for each: sum=2(1 way),3(2),5(4),7(6),11(2) = 15 outcomes. Probability = $15/36$.

Q: Method — basic single-die probability: What is the probability of throwing a number greater than 4 on a single die?

A: Numbers greater than 4 on a standard die: 5 and 6 — that's 2 out of 6 outcomes. Probability = $2/6 = 1/3$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. On a standard die, the numbers on opposite faces always sum to:

- A. 6
- B. 7 ✓**
- C. 8
- D. 9

Explanation: 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4). [easy, authored]

2. What is the probability of getting a sum of 7 when two dice are thrown?

- A. $1/12$
- B. $1/9$
- C. $1/6$ ✓**
- D. $1/4$

Explanation: 6 ways to make 7 out of 36 total outcomes: $6/36=1/6$. [medium, authored]

3. What is the probability of throwing an odd number on a single die?

- A. $1/6$
- B. $1/3$
- C. $1/2$ ✓**
- D. $2/3$

Explanation: Odd numbers (1,3,5) = 3 of 6 outcomes = $1/2$. [easy, authored]

4. If face 1 is adjacent to faces 2, 3, 4, and 5 on a die, which face must be opposite face 1?

- A. 2
- B. 3
- C. 4

D. 6 ✓

Explanation: Since 2,3,4,5 are all adjacent to 1, the only remaining face (6) must be opposite it. [medium, authored]

5. What is the probability of getting a sum greater than 10 when two dice are thrown?

A. $1/36$

B. $1/12$ ✓

C. $1/9$

D. $1/6$

Explanation: Sums >10 means 11 (2 ways) or 12 (1 way) = 3 outcomes out of 36 = $1/12$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "The Night the Ghost Got In" — James Thurber

READING MATERIAL

A humorous true-life anecdote by James Thurber about a chaotic night in his childhood home in Columbus, Ohio, when his family mistook mysterious footstep sounds for a ghost — leading to a comically exaggerated police response, ending in an anticlimactic, unexplained resolution.

Q: Who wrote "The Night the Ghost Got In", and on what date does the story say the incident happened?

A: James (Grover) Thurber. The story specifies the date as 17 November 1915.

Q: Who first heard the mysterious footsteps, what was he doing at the time, and what was the ghost apparently doing downstairs?

A: The narrator (young Thurber) first heard the footsteps while he was in the bathtub. The sound seemed to be someone/something walking in a circle around the dining-room table downstairs.

Q: Who was sleeping in the attic during the incident, and how did the mother react to get help?

A: The grandfather was asleep in the attic throughout most of the commotion (and later caused his own comic confusion when woken). The mother, unable to phone calmly, threw a shoe through a neighbor's (Mr. Bodwell's) window to wake him and get help.

Q: How did the police respond to the call, and in what state was the narrator when they arrived?

A: The police arrived in dramatically excessive force — a Ford car, motorcycles, AND a patrol wagon — for what turned out to be a false alarm. The narrator was seen by the police wearing only a towel.

Q: What did the police find suspicious about the house, and what unusual objects did they discover?

A: They found all the doors and windows locked from the inside (suspicious, since it suggested no intruder could have entered or left) — and they discovered a zither in the house, which a pet guinea pig used to sleep on.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The Night the Ghost Got In" was written by:

- A. Liam O'Flaherty
- B. James Thurber ✓**
- C. Ruskin Bond
- D. Mark Twain

Explanation: James (Grover) Thurber. [easy, web-research]

2. According to the story, the ghost allegedly entered the house on:

- A. 25 December 1914
- B. 17 November 1915 ✓**
- C. 1 January 1920
- D. 13 October 1900

Explanation: 17 November 1915. [medium, web-research]

3. Who first heard the ghost's footsteps, and what was he doing at the time?

- A. The narrator, while in the bathtub ✓**
- B. Grandfather, while sleeping
- C. Mother, while cooking
- D. Roy, while reading

Explanation: The narrator, while in the bathtub. [medium, web-research]

4. The mysterious sound downstairs seemed to be something:

- A. Banging on the door
- B. Walking around the dining table ✓**
- C. Crying in the basement
- D. Climbing the stairs

Explanation: Walking around the table. [medium, web-research]

5. Who was sleeping in the attic during the commotion?

- A. Herman

B. Grandfather ✓

C. The narrator

D. Roy

Explanation: Grandfather. [easy, web-research]

6. How did the mother get help during the incident?

A. She called the police directly

B. She ran out into the street

C. She threw a shoe through the neighbor's window ✓

D. She wrote a note and left it outside

Explanation: She threw a shoe through Mr. Bodwell's window. [medium, web-research]

7. How did the police arrive at the house, reflecting the story's comic exaggeration?

A. Quietly, in one car

B. With a Ford, motorcycles, and a patrol wagon ✓

C. On foot

D. With fire engines

Explanation: A Ford, motorcycles, and a patrol wagon. [medium, web-research]

8. What was the narrator wearing when the police saw him?

A. A suit

B. A nightgown

C. Just a towel ✓

D. Shirt and trousers

Explanation: Just a towel. [easy, web-research]

9. What did the police find suspicious about the house?

A. Open doors

B. Unlocked windows

C. All doors and windows locked from inside ✓

D. Strange footprints outside

Explanation: All doors and windows were locked from the inside. [medium, web-research]

10. What musical instrument did the police find in the house, and what pet used to sleep on it?

A. A violin; a cat

B. A zither; a guinea pig ✓

C. A piano; a dog

D. A harp; a hamster

Explanation: A zither, which the family's guinea pig used to sleep on. [hard, web-research]